W-A-450/7
JANUARY 3, 1992

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

DETECTOR, VIBRATION

This specification is approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION.

1.1 Scope. The W-A-450C specification covers intrusion detection equipment which is deployed as a system to include, but is not to be limited to, detection of intrusions relating to protection of national security information, sensitive information and equipment, high dollar items, and weapons. The intrusion detection equipment, when selectively assembled, provides interior detection capabilities specifically designed for security application.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Unit and type. This specification covers Unit Number 1, Type VII, Vibration Detector.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS.

The documents listed in W-A-450C/GEN, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

3. REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 Qualification. The vibration detector furnished under this specification shall be a product which is qualified for listing on the applicable qualified products list. It shall conform to the minimum specifications required herein and shall have been tested and shall have passed the qualification tests specified in paragraph 4.1.

3.2 Temperature and humidity ranges.

3.2.1 Operating range. All equipment shall be capable of operating within the temperature and humidity ranges indicated below:

0 degrees C to +49 degrees C and relative humidity of 0% to 85%, non-condensing.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 6350

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

All units shall withstand the tests in paragraphs 4.1.3 through 4.1.5. Additional requirements may be imposed by the procuring entity.

3.2.2 Nonoperating range. All equipment which is not powered up shall be capable of withstanding, without damage, the temperature range indicated below:

-46 degrees C to 71 degrees C.

3.3 Dependability. All equipment supplied under this specification shall have a minimum Mean Time Between Failure (MTBF) of 10 000 hours.

3.4 Operation. The vibration detector shall consist of a vibration sensing unit, which by itself or in conjunction with other elements can cause either an electrical change in resistance across the detector's alarm switch or a change in total loop current in the case of a current loop shunt type detector.

The change in resistance may be from a low resistance (short) to a high resistance (open), or from a high resistance (open) to a low resistance (short). If the detector's alarm switch is solid state, when in the low resistance state, the alarm switch shall not cause a voltage drop of more than one volt. If the detector is a current loop shunt type detector, the alarm current must change a minimum of 1000 times, with a minimum loop current of not more than 50.0 uA. The vibration detector shall, after initial setup, stabilize within five minutes after being powered on and after any alarm initiating stimulus is removed. Input power shall be 8 to 18 volts DC, reverse polarity protected, or 10 to 28 volts AC RMS, 60 cps. Single-pole, double-throw alarm switch or relay and separate single-pole, double-throw tamper switch or relay connections shall be provided at a terminal strip for connection to external alarm reporting equipment. Alarm and tamper switch impedance shall be as follows:

Open state:
- greater than 100 000 ohms.

Closed state:
- For solid state relays - less than 50 ohms.
- For mechanical relays - 0.1 ohms or less.

Upon the detector's alarm circuitry activating, it must either maintain it's alarm signaling state for a minimum of one second then reset, or must latch in it's alarm state until cleared.

3.4.1 Additional capabilities. The manufacturer is encouraged to provide information in their technical literature concerning performance data that would exceed the minimum

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

requirements of this specification.

3.5 Vibration detector enclosure. The detector assembly shall be a sealed one piece unit with cable leads or a multiple piece unit with a tamper switch protected cover. If there is a removable cover, it shall be arranged to provide ready access for mounting, wiring, alignment, and for sensitivity and other internal adjustments. Mounting holes shall be provided in the back of the enclosure in positions that are readily accessible (sufficiently displaced from all internal parts and the enclosure side) when all internal parts and wiring are in place. No external hardware or fasteners except the cover fasteners shall be used to provide ready access for mounting, wiring, and adjustment of sensitivity or other internal adjustments. An alternate method of mounting the detector is to use a manufacturer's recommended or provided adhesive or tape.

3.6 Cover. The transmitter unit and receiver unit covers shall be designed such that any attempted access to the interior shall cause a tamper condition. The tamper circuits shall be in the secure state whenever the cover is in place and shall go to their alarm state when the cover is moved sufficiently to reveal the inside or to introduce a defeating device. The tamper switch shall be constructed of corrosion resistant materials and operate smoothly to prevent jamming.

3.7 Terminals. Screw terminals shall be provided for interconnecting wiring. Access to the terminals shall require removal of the enclosure cover. An alternate method of connection is through the detector's non-removable cable leads.

3.8 Switch and/or relay assembly. Alarm and tamper switch and/or relay contacts shall be protected against environmental and excessive current conditions which may be damaging. Sustained currents up to 1.33 times the published current rating shall not cause damage to the switch or contacts.

3.9 Size, weight and power consumption. The size, weight and power consumption of each unit shall be the minimum practicable, consistent with meeting the requirements of this specification and shall be stated in the manufacturer's literature.

3.10 Maintainability. The vibration detector shall be designed and constructed in such a manner as to minimize maintenance and repair time. To the maximum extent practicable, items shall be of a modular, unitized construction. Components shall be so arranged and assembled that they are readily visible and accessible to maintenance personnel. Specialized training is not required to maintain this equipment. Field maintenance shall

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

consist of trouble shooting and isolation of failures to the device or replaceable sub-assembly and replacement of the defective device or sub-assembly. Preventive maintenance may be required. Adjustments shall require no disassembly of the detector beyond mere removal of the cover.

3.11 Life cycle. The vibration detector alarm and tamper switches and/or relays shall be rated at not fewer than 1 000 000 operations under a load of 250 milliampere driven from a 48 volt DC source. Contact resistance shall not change more than +20% from the initial reading.

3.13 EMI compatibility. Units shall operate normally when subjected to the testing of 4.1.6. The testing shall neither inhibit valid alarms nor generate invalid alarms.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 Tests.

4.1.1 Performance test. The unit being tested shall be mounted on a single axis shaker table equipped with a calibrated reference accelerometer. It shall be mounted in a manner as to maintain proper orientation as per manufacturer's recommendations (see figure 1).

4.1.1.1 Alarm sensitivity. The shaker table shall be driven at the manufacturer's published frequencies in 10% steps with sufficient drive signal amplitude to measure a mean acceleration of 0.5 g on the reference accelerometer. Each frequency shall have a 250 ms duration. If no frequencies are stated by the manufacturer then 500 to 10 000 Hz in increments of 500 Hz shall be used.

The detector shall alarm at each published frequency or over a continuous range of 5000 Hz if no frequency range is published.

If there is a sensitivity control on the detector, it shall be set at maximum for these tests.

4.1.1.2. Low frequency sensitivity test. The shaker table shall be driven from 10 to 100 Hz at 10 Hz increments with sufficient drive signal amplitude to measure a maximum mean acceleration of 0.01 g on the reference accelerometer. Each frequency shall have a 250 ms duration.

The detector shall not alarm at any of the test frequencies.

If there is a sensitivity control on the detector, it shall be set at minimum for these tests.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

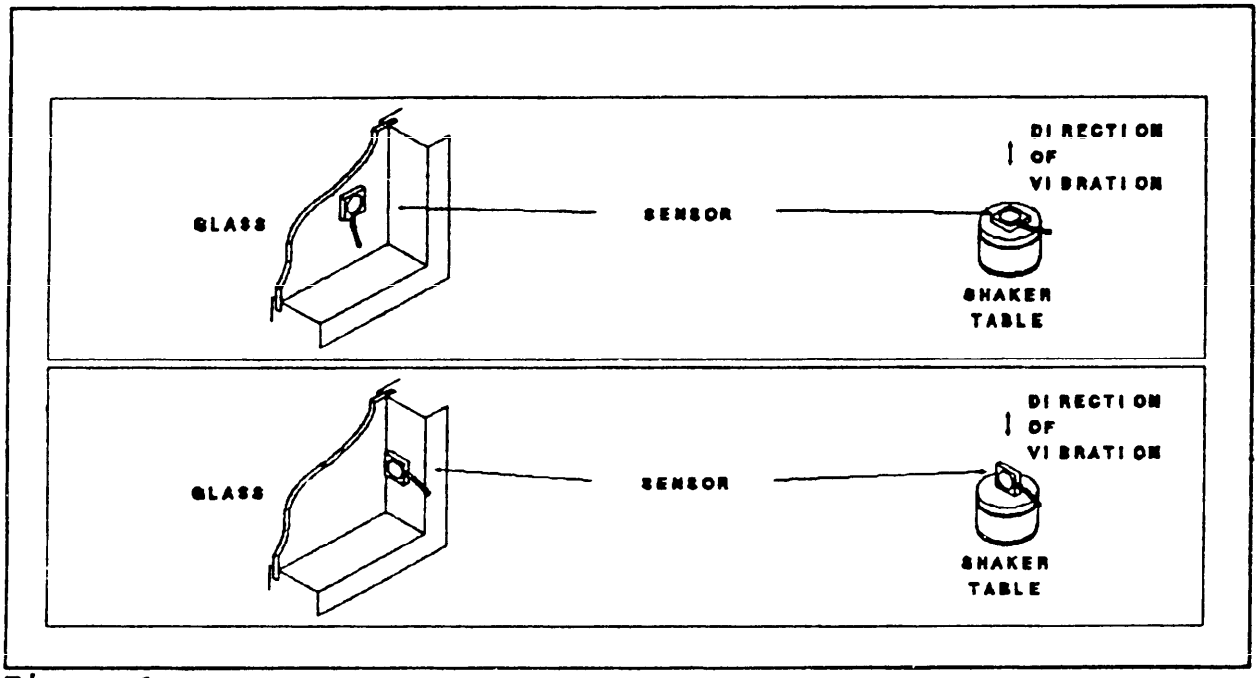


Figure 1

4.1.2 Stability test. The unit submitted for qualification testing shall perform its intended function in a stable environment free of stimuli that would initiate a nuisance alarm. The test period shall be 90 days of continuous operation with any adjusted controls set to provide the specified security. The test period shall commence after the unit has been installed in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions and after a "shakedown" operational period of not more than seven consecutive days.

4.1.3 High temperature test. Units submitted for qualification shall be energized for a period of four hours at 49 degrees C. The unit shall be tested as specified in paragraph 4.1.1 with the temperature maintained at 49 degrees C. During this period, there shall be no alarms other than those resulting from the performance of the tests of 4.1.1. The temperature must be stabilized for 5 minutes before the test period commences.

4.1.4 Low temperature test. Units submitted for qualification shall be energized for a period of four hours at 0 degrees C. The unit shall then be tested as specified in paragraph 4.1.1 with the temperature maintained at 0 degrees C. During this period, there shall be no alarms other than those resulting from the performance of the tests of 4.1.1. The temperature must be stabilized for 5 minutes before the test period commences.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1.5 Humidity test. Units submitted for qualification shall be energized for a period of four hours with the humidity maintained at 85% at a maintained temperature of at least 26 degrees C. The test chamber shall be vented to the atmosphere to prevent the accumulation of moisture. The unit shall be tested as specified in paragraph 4.1.1 with the temperature maintained at 26 degrees C and the humidity maintained at 85%. During this period, there shall be no alarms other than those resulting from the performance of the tests of 4.1.1. The temperature and humidity must be stabilized for 5 minutes before the test period commences.

4.1.6 EMI compatibility test. Units shall be tested for compliance with 3.13 in accordance with the applicable tests of MIL-STD-462 with consideration of the following paragraphs:

4.1.6.1 Test chamber. All testing shall be performed in an EMI test chamber.

4.1.6.2 Conducted electromagnetic susceptibility test. The units shall be subjected to power line conducted interference in accordance with test methods CS01, CS02, and CS06 of MIL-STD-462. Maintain a test level of 1 or 3 Volts RMS as required over the entire frequency range.

4.1.6.3 Radiated electromagnetic susceptibility test. The units shall be subjected to radiation in accordance with test method RS03 of MIL-STD-462. Use an electric field of 1 Volt per meter for frequencies in the range of 14 Khz. to 2 Mhz. and 3 Volts per meter for frequencies in the range of 2 Mhz. to 12 Ghz.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY.

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing and marking shall be in accordance with ASTM D3951. The level of packing shall be A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Civil agency marking. In addition to any special markings (see 6.2) required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Sensor systems constructed with components qualified under this specification are intended to supplement or support protective personnel (e.g., guards) for areas requiring special security measures. These properly assembled systems are resistive to neutralization or to compromise by covert or surreptitious attack. Guidance in selecting a particular item for

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

a particular security situation is not intended and is beyond the scope of this document. Qualification approval merely means that the item meets the specification requirements at the time it was tested for qualification.

6.2 Ordering data. The purchaser should exercise any desired options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, symbol, and date of this specification.
(b) Type of coverage (detection pattern) required (where applicable).
(c) Quantities required.
(d) Spare parts required.
(e) Destination inspection required.
(f) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1).
(g) Special marking required (see 5.2)
(h) Shipping schedule required.

6.3 Qualification. Regarding products which require qualification under this specification, awards will be made only for products which have been tested and approved for inclusion on the applicable Federal Qualified Products List prior to the time set for opening of bids whether or not such products have actually been listed. The attention of suppliers is called to this requirement, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products they propose to offer the Federal Government tested for qualification so that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for products covered by this specification. The activity responsible for the Qualified Products List is:

General Services Administration
Federal Supply Service, Furniture Commodity Center
Washington, DC. 20406

Information pertaining to qualification may be obtained from that activity.

6.4 Definitions.

6.4.1 Alarms.

6.4.1.1 Valid alarm. A valid alarm is any alarm generated by stimuli which the detector is designed to recognize and which satisfies the detector's stated alarm criteria.

6.4.1.2 Invalid alarm. Any other alarm.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.